

SECTION 6: BLOWDOWN SYSTEM SOP

Purpose: To safely reduce sediment accumulation and maintain boiler water quality by periodically discharging water from the boiler, bottom blowdown, and surface blowdown systems.

Procedures:

- Confirm blowdown tank is empty and vented.
- Verify water level is within safe limits before initiating blowdown.
- Open blowdown valve slowly to avoid thermal shock.
- Observe pressure drop and maintain for 10–20 seconds.
- Close valve gradually to prevent hammering.
- Log time, pressure, and temperature during blowdown.
- Inspect valve integrity and piping after blowdown.

Notes:

- Bottom blowdown should be performed daily or as specified.
- Surface blowdown frequency depends on conductivity and TDS testing.
- Never perform blowdown with low water levels.